ABSOLUTE / UPAJ

# Payment and ERP workflows for commodity trade

A shared transaction record for finance and operations, built around the realities of cross-border settlement.

Role: Product leadership across the Absolute portfolio | Period: October 2021–November 2024

## Reported outcomes and scope

5 days → 1 day · Reported settlement cycle

−80% · Reported complaint tickets

70–80% · Reported leakage reduction

The earlier source expresses this as a range.

## The product problem

Cross-border trades combined large payments, multiple currencies, regulatory checks and shipping documents. Fragmented tools and manual reconciliation made it difficult for finance and operations to see the same state of a trade.

## My role

I worked with engineering and finance on the custom payment-gateway and ERP requirements inside SilkRoute’s transaction lifecycle. My scope included payment failures, reconciliation and the operational requirements around trade execution.

## What I built

The gateway was designed for large-ticket trade flows rather than a generic retail checkout. The ERP connected trade legs and gave finance and operations a common record.

Regulatory and customs requirements, CHA and challan documentation were brought into the transaction process. The product work involved both the steps users completed and the checks required before a trade could progress.

## Connecting payment with the trade record

I investigated payment failures and worked with finance on reconciliation needs. The gateway was developed around the commodity-trade lifecycle, with IDFC named as the banking partner in the Professional Profile. The in-house ERP then connected the internal trade record with the customer transaction and the work finance and operations had to complete.

I worked directly with engineering on system design and with finance on reconciliation logic. This gave the product work an operating sequence: understand the trade, identify the payment and document requirements, connect them with the internal record, and make the completed or unresolved outcome visible to the teams responsible for it.

## Trade documentation and customer complaints

The requirements included customs documentation, CHA and challan handling alongside transaction checks. These were part of the workflow rather than detached files to be assembled after the payment. The system connected large-ticket payment handling with the regulatory and physical trade requirements described in the source.

The programme’s results cover three distinct problems: how long settlement took, how much financial leakage remained and how many complaint tickets arrived. I worked across technology, business, finance and operations on those connected changes. The reported five-day to one-day settlement cycle, 70–80% leakage reduction and 80% complaint reduction are kept at that combined programme level.

## What changed

The gateway and ERP programme reports settlement moving from five days to one day, complaint tickets falling 80% and financial leakage falling approximately 70–80%. These are separate operating measures across the connected payment and process changes.

## The lesson from this work

The useful lesson in this case is an operating-system one: reducing transaction friction depends on shared state and clear exception handling. Payment execution, finance records and physical trade documentation must agree.

## Visual references and walkthroughs

Documented workflow: Trade and finance records → Compliance and shipping documents → Payment workflows → Ledger reconciliation → Settlement and complaint handling

An authored explanation of the workflow described in this case study. This is a diagram, not a captured product screen.

View the online case study for the full image gallery and playable videos.

# Evidence and attribution

Outcome wording follows the earlier career record; later real-time settlement claims are not merged into it.

Later CV wording says real-time settlement; the earlier five-day to one-day result is used here. Leakage baseline/currency amount, complaint denominator and settlement comparison cohorts are not supplied.